enduring single entity with a fixed identity – in short, a soul (***atman***). This mistaken perspective on life generates selfishness, attachments, fearful hostility to whatever we think poses a threat to our personal wants, and a thirst for more experiences, which we can call our own. They deny that anything made of parts is ultimately real. Basic realities are in a state of ceaseless change (***Kshanikatva***). There are no permanent identities and thus no real distinction between enduring entities and their properties. Reality is basically an impersonal process.

The truths are:

1. All compounded and conditioned things are ultimately unsatisfactory (***Duhkha/Dukkha***). This is the eternal round of existences (***samsara***). A mode of existence is determined by the quality of the accumulated ***karma*** in a stream of experiences that temporarily forms a succession of lives.

   Universal unsatisfactoriness is attributed to the impermanence (*anitya*; *anicca*) and non-substantiality (*anatma*; ***anatta***) of all conditioned entities. Buddhism propounds anti-essentialist and reductionist theories in its process or event ontologies. What appear to be stable and integral spatio-temporal continuants are reduced to temporary parts; human lives are analysed into streams of causally interdependent psychophysical components (***skandhas***) that do not amount to an enduring, substantial self or soul. Selfhood is a fiction that the fluxes of experiences conventionally called persons superimpose upon themselves. Attempts to cling to what is unstable and impermanent are bound to end in disappointed frustration.
2. The second truth discovered by the Buddha is that there is a causal explanation (***pratitya-samutpada***) for the arising of unsatisfactoriness in terms of 'thirst', which